

VISHNU RAVEENDRAN



GAME DEVELOPER · UNREAL ENGINE · PC · CONSOLE · VR

Unreal Engine

C++

C#

Blueprints

VR Development

PSVR2 / Certops

Multi-platform Shipping

PS5

Xbox

Switch 2

PS5 Haptics

ForceSeat SDK

Hardware Integration

Unity

Photon PUN

Git

Online Leaderboards

Character Creator 3

Game Design

Level Design

Agile

Photoshop

HTML

JavaScript

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Gameplay programmer with 5+ years of commercial experience across VR, PC, and console. Sole or lead programmer on every shipped title — including the first PSVR2 game from the Middle East. Delivered bespoke hardware integration for location-based installations, high-profile client experiences for Discovery Channel and KSA government projects, and represented the studio at Tokyo Game Show, PlayStation Develop, and BLAST Premier World Final.

WORK EXPERIENCE

KHOSOUF STUDIO · Abu Dhabi, UAE

Lead Developer

Oct 2021 – Jun 2026

- Shipped **Box To The Beat VR** across PSVR2, Steam, Meta Quest & Rift, HTC Vive, and PICO VR as sole programmer — first PSVR2 game from the Middle East; Sony engine-level code, certops, PSVR2 haptics, Beat Saber custom map compatibility
- Shipped **Astral Hound VR** and **HOPE VR** (both live on Steam) as lead developer; Astral Hound: all gameplay systems, full VR level design, 18-character pipeline via Character Creator 3 with Headshot plugin
- Built **Ocean Explorer VR** for Discovery Channel — physical simulator chair over raw serial protocol with no SDK: custom binary message format, byte-packed 3-axis motion data, CRC16 checksums; drove fans, water spray, and EM lock via second hardware board and JSON device mapping; UAE and international deployment
- Delivered **Jeddah Central VR**, official experience for one of KSA's largest urban development projects; presented to government authorities in Saudi Arabia
- Built **A Hunter's Journey**, UAE cultural heritage experience demonstrated to Sheikh Khaled Bin Zayed at Al-Hosn Festival; interactive constellation system developed with UAE astronomy authority; global online leaderboard; multi-event Abu Dhabi deployment
- Integrated ForceSeat motion platform for **Asteroid Assault VR**; built online leaderboard and playtest data API; QA consultant across all 10 VR experiences pre-launch at Pixoul Gaming, Al Qana, Abu Dhabi
- Leading **The Panic Pit** and **Glitchcore** (in active development at departure) — FPS roguelites for PC, PS5, Xbox, and Switch 2; full combat systems, multi-phase bosses, parkour with wall running, procedural generation, PS5 haptics, achievements system
- Represented studio at Tokyo Game Show 2024 (Abu Dhabi Gaming), BLAST Premier World Final 2023 (\$1M CS2 final, Etihad Arena), PlayStation Develop 2023, MEFECC (3x exhibitor), and GITECH Global 2021

Intern Trainer (concurrent)

Oct 2022 – Oct 2024

- Mentored 4–5 interns over 2 years; assigned tasks, reviewed code, taught studio workflows alongside full-time development responsibilities
- Intern contributions shipped in Box To The Beat VR across 6 VR platforms

Game Developer (internship)

Nov 2020 – Oct 2021

- Contributed to HOPE VR (shipped on Steam); prototyped AI meditation assistant with voice controls and conversational interaction
- Built Unity companion app for Shadow Dreams: lore codex, 3D model viewer, music player, in-app rhythm game, and QR code easter egg system

SANDOOQ AL WATAN · Abu Dhabi, UAE

Coding Instructor

Jul 2023 – Aug 2023

- Taught game design and Scratch coding to children aged 8–15 at a government-backed UAE initiative under Erth Zayed Philanthropies; large-scale annual program attracting thousands of participants
- Received Certificate of Appreciation on completion

KNOTGAMES · UAE (self-founded)

Game Developer

Jan 2021 – Feb 2022

- Pablo Let's Go Bar** (Steam, online co-op FPS roguelite) — full enemy AI across multiple types, grenade cooking mechanic with trajectory preview, Photon PUN networking (spawning, enemy sync, networked death), tarot card modifier system, loot and upgrade shop, fully rebindable input manager with save/load; Won Best Studio Project, SAE Institute Dubai 2021
- Hotel California** (online PvP puzzle) — 4 networked puzzle types (jigsaw, replica, radio tuning, Morse code) with correctly synchronised state across all clients via Photon; networked character selection, settings, and end screens
- Social media, Discord community, and player feedback management for both shipped titles

ACHIEVEMENTS

Global Game Jam 2024 Winner · Best Game Crash 'N' Cash	NYX Game Awards 2023 Winner · Best PC VR Game Box To The Beat VR	NYX Game Awards 2021 Winner · Best PC Shooter Shadow Dreams / The Panic Pit
SAE Institute Showcase 2021 Winner · Best Studio Game Pablo Let's Go Bar	Heritage Gameathon 2026 Runner-Up · Best Game Atlantis of the Sands	First PSVR2 title — Middle East Box To The Beat VR PSVR2 · Steam · Meta · HTC · PICO

EDUCATION

SAE INSTITUTE DUBAI · Dubai, UAE

Bachelor of Games Development · Games Programming

2018 – 2022

Degree awarded 22 February 2022

BACKGROUND

LANGUAGES

English	S/R/W: Native
Hindi	S/R/W: Fluent
Malayalam	S: Native · R/W: Intermediate
Arabic	S: Basic · R/W: Fluent
Urdu	S/R/W: Intermediate

CERTIFICATIONS

- IELTS
2019 · Band 8.0
- ADEK Program Your Idea
Certification · Abu Dhabi
- Sandooq Al Watan
Certificate of Appreciation